

Santi Giovanni e Paolo, *Il ritorno d'Ulisse in patria* (The Return of Ulysses to his Homeland) and *L'incoronazione di Poppea* (The Coronation of Poppea), were dramatic masterpieces that exhibited a range of distinctive characters in emotionally realistic situations. Immediately successful, they undoubtedly did more than any other works to establish opera as a major genre of the future.

When Monteverdi died in 1643, he was honored with a tomb in Venice's splendid Frari church. After falling from favor, his music was rediscovered in the 20th century, along with the techniques and instruments that were required to perform it authentically. A bridge between the Renaissance period and the Baroque, his work is enjoyed by modern listeners for its emotional intensity and sheer beauty of sound.



*L'INCORONAZIONE DI POPPEA*

Monteverdi's last opera, *L'incoronazione di Poppea* (1643), tells the story of Emperor Nero's love for his mistress. The production shown here is from a 2017 performance at the Staatsoper in Berlin, Germany. The performance was notable